

The Not For You Page: Algorithmic Design for User Disengagement

Abstract. Algorithmic recommendation systems across modern digital platforms are predominantly engineered to maximize user engagement, retention, and time on platform. While effective for commercial metrics, these continuous feed architectures frequently lead to digital fatigue, compulsive consumption, and diminished user agency. This paper explores the concept of the “Not For You Page” (NFYP), an alternative feed model designed to investigate how recommendation systems can be re-oriented toward disengagement and user well-being. By examining mechanisms that introduce intentional friction and alter content distribution, this research evaluates how algorithmic design can encourage voluntary platform exit. The project addresses the feasibility of embedding digital well-being directly into recommendation logic, offering a counter perspective to traditional retention focused platform architectures.

1. Introduction

Feed-based recommendation engines serve as the foundational interface for modern content discovery. Driven by retention metrics, these architectures continuously adapt to user behavior to capture and sustain attention. However, the systematic optimization of screen time increasingly conflicts with user autonomy, giving rise to digital burnout and cognitive overload. Current interventions for digital well-being rely almost exclusively on external controls, such as application timers or system level access restrictions, leaving the underlying algorithms largely unexamined as tools for self-regulation.

To address this issue, this project examines the “Not For You Page” (NFYP), a conceptual recommendation model that inverts conventional retention objectives. Rather than reinforcing engagement loops, the system explores methods

to systematically reduce content resonance and introduce friction as usage continues. This research investigates the theoretical foundation of anti-retention algorithm design, outlining potential mechanisms for disengagement and discussing their broader implications for human-computer interaction and ethical platform development.

1.1. Related work

Works related to your paper

2. Methodology

2.1. Methodology subsection

Your methodology

3. Results

A	B	C
A1	B1	C1
A2	B2	C2
A3	B3	C3
A4	B4	C4

Table 1. The summary of the table

Reference to the Table 1 on page 2 and a cite [1].

4. Discussion

Your discussion

Acknowledgment

Your acknowledgement

References

- [1] P. Sabanal and M. Yason. “Reversing C++”. In: Black Hat DC. 2007.

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